THE WOLF OF McKENZIE TOWNE • SEASON ONE

A PROPOSAL TO THE McKENZIE TOWNE COUNCIL

Founding Partnership & Funding Request • The Wolf of McKenzie Towne

"Seek the welfare of the city… for in its welfare you will find your welfare."

Prepared for Keith Dsouza, President, and the Board of Directors

Season One Founding Partnership

Season One • August 2027

October 2026 • Confidential to the MTC Board

Executive Summary

The opportunity. *The Wolf of McKenzie Towne* is a youth-led, community-wide event planned for **late August 2027**. Teams of local teens will race through McKenzie Towne's themed parks, the High Street and Elgin Hill in an Amazing Race-style adventure. It ends with a dusk finale at which the community relights a symbolic "Lantern" and residents switch on their porch lights together. The event is designed and run by a council of 10–12 teens, supported by screened adult volunteers and post-secondary student mentors.

Why it matters to the McKenzie Towne Council. McKenzie Towne was planned as a village, with porches, squares, a High Street and themed parks. This event puts that design to work. It brings residents into Council-maintained spaces, engages teenagers (the age group community organizations most often miss), and gives the Towne a new annual tradition with the Council's name on it.

What we are asking. We request that the McKenzie Towne Council ("the Council") become the event's **Founding Partner**:

Component	Amount	How it is used
Core contribution	**$5,000**	Released on approval. Funds planning, safeguarding, insurance and the matching share required by City grants.
Match-contingent fund	**up to $10,000**	Held by the Council. Released **only dollar-for-dollar against confirmed grant and sponsor funding**, in two tranches (February and May 2027).
In-kind support	est. **$3,800**	Use of McKenzie Towne Hall for planning sessions, a build space and race-day headquarters; Prestwick Common as a station; the Council's communication channels; and prop storage for Season Two.
Total commitment	**up to $15,000 cash + in-kind**	

The safeguard. The Council's money is protected by design. Two-thirds of the cash is released only when outside funding is secured, every dollar is reported, and **unspent funds are returned**.

What the Council receives. Presenting-partner billing (*"The Wolf of McKenzie Towne, presented by the McKenzie Towne Council"*), naming of the finale (*"The McKenzie Towne Council Lantern Lighting"*), a speaking role at the finale, visibility on every channel and printed piece, a youth presentation to the Board, a full impact report, and first right to partner on Season Two.

The decision requested. Approval of the Founding Partner commitment, by the motion set out in Part 10.

PART 1

The Event at a Glance

What	An Amazing Race-style adventure for teens aged 13–18, in teams ("clans") of four
When	A Saturday evening in late August 2027 (date to be confirmed), about 5:30–9:30 p.m.
Where	McKenzie Towne Hall, High Street, Firetruck Park, Pirate & Castle Park, Inverness Square, Elgin Ship and Dragon playgrounds, Promenade Park and Elgin Hill
Who	50–70 teen racers; a Youth Race Council of 10–12 teen leaders; 30+ adult volunteers; post-secondary student mentors; families and neighbours as audience
Story	A light-hearted legend drawn from the Towne's Scottish street names. A "Wolf" has stolen the Lantern of the North, and the teens must recover it by dusk.
Finale	The Lantern is relit at dusk, and residents across the Towne switch on their porch lights
Also	An afternoon "Cubs' Quest" for younger children at the themed playgrounds

The event is youth-led by design. The Youth Race Council, which includes the President and Vice-President of a local 4-H club, works through a structured twelve-step planning program over the coming months. Adults hold responsibility for safety, finances, permits and approvals.

PART 2

Why This Fits the Council's Mandate

The McKenzie Towne Council owns, maintains and manages McKenzie Towne's shared amenities, and enriches resident life through programming and community events. This proposal supports that mandate in five ways:

1. **It shows off the Council's amenities.** The event is built around Council-maintained spaces and the Towne's distinctive design. Residents and visitors will see the parks, the Hall and the High Street at their best.
2. **It reaches teens.** The Council already serves young children and families well. Teenagers are harder to reach, and this event gives them a reason to engage with the community and its spaces.
3. **It builds the Council's future volunteers.** Teens who lead this event become the next generation of Council volunteers, program leaders and engaged residents.
4. **It strengthens neighbour relationships.** Porch-cheer streets, the community finale and the porch-light moment turn a resident base into a neighbourhood.
5. **It complements, rather than competes with, the Council's event calendar.** It fills a late-summer gap alongside the Council's established events, such as Music in the Park, Halloween Spooktacular and the Christmas Craft Fair, and can become an annual tradition.

How we will protect the Council's spaces. The themed playgrounds are built for young children, so teens will use them as backdrops and complete tasks beside the equipment, not on it. Stormwater ponds are strictly off-limits. Every park is left cleaner than we found it.

PART 3

Governance and Safeguarding

Structure

- **Youth Race Council (10–12 teens):** designs the game, story and publicity; runs stations on race day.
- **Adult Steering Group:** Event Lead, Safety Officer, Finance Lead and Volunteer Lead. Holds all legal, financial and safety responsibility.
- **Council Liaison (requested):** one Council director or staff member as observer on the Steering Group, with full visibility and minimal time (about one meeting a month).
- **Student mentors:** post-secondary marketing and theatre students on supervised placements.

Safeguarding commitments

- Police information checks with vulnerable-sector verification for every adult volunteer and student mentor
- The two-adult rule at all times, and group-only communication with youth
- Parental consent, waivers, medical and allergy forms, and photo consent for every participant
- The race-day "chase" game confined to a coned, lit, marshalled zone on Elgin Hill, using flag belts only
- Walk-only zones on every street and crossing; no access to stormwater ponds
- Certified first aid on site, and a weather plan that moves activities into McKenzie Towne Hall

Insurance. Special-event liability coverage will be arranged, either through a dedicated event policy or by confirming coverage with the Council's insurer, with the McKenzie Towne Council named as an additional insured. **No activity proceeds without confirmed coverage.**

Conflict of interest. Any Council director involved in organizing this event will declare the interest and abstain from the Council's discussion and vote on this proposal.

PART 4

Budget

The full budget is in the companion workbook (*Wolf-of-McKenzie-Towne-Budget.xlsx*). It is presented at two levels:

- **Lean:** a scrappy first year with borrowed equipment and minimal paid roles.
- **Target:** delivered properly, with paid summer students, a co-op term and full production values.

Category	Lean	Target
Student mentors & placements	$5,854	$26,318
Planning sessions	$1,097	$2,950
Costumes & sets	$1,579	$3,454
Race-day operations	$470	$2,794
Marketing & media	$393	$2,140
Food (race day & finale)	$925	$2,283
Recognition & thanks	$660	$1,700
Insurance, permits & safety	$480	$1,605
Contingency (10% / 15%)	$1,146	$6,487
Total	**$12,603**	**$49,730**

About student costs. About half the Target budget is student wages and placements. These costs are **largely offset by federal wage subsidies** if approved: Canada Summer Jobs covers up to 100% of minimum wage for non-profits, and the Student Work Placement Program covers about 50% of co-op wages. Without paid student roles, the event costs about **$19,500** at the Target level.

PART 5

Funding Plan

Our strategy is to apply to every eligible source, and to ask each one for its maximum. We know many funders will award less than we ask, and some won't fund us at all. Applying broadly and asking boldly is how a first-year community event reaches its Target budget. The full research is in the companion *Funding Opportunities Register* (26 sources reviewed: federal, provincial, municipal, foundation and corporate).

Season One sources (2027 event)

Source	Level	Focus	Maximum ask	Timing
Alberta Community Initiatives Program (CIP) Project Grant	Provincial	Community	$75,000	15 Feb 2027 (decision ~Aug)
City of Calgary Arts & Culture Microgrant, Tier 2	Municipal	Arts & culture	$30,000	~March 2027
AFA Arts Presenting Project Funding	Provincial	Arts & culture	$20,000	1 Dec 2026
Canada Summer Jobs (2 production assistants, 16 weeks)	Federal	Students	$18,800	27 Oct – ~3 Dec 2026
Federation of Calgary Communities: Good Places	Federation	Community	$15,000	30 Oct 2026
City of Calgary Inspiring Neighbourhoods Grant	Municipal	Community	$15,000	Rolling (**equal match required**)
Calgary Foundation Neighbour Grants	Foundation	Community	$10,000	9 Nov 2026
Ward 12 Community Event Fund	Municipal	Community	$10,000	Opens 15 Dec 2026
Alberta Culture Days (if race weekend moves to September)	Provincial	Arts & culture	$10,000	~March 2027
Brookfield Residential (the community's original developer)	Corporate	Community	$10,000	Jan–Mar 2027
High Street merchants and local businesses	Corporate	Community	$10,000	Jan–May 2027
Student Work Placement Program (co-op)	Federal	Students	$7,000	Year-round
Burns Memorial Fund (bursaries, via a charity partner)	Foundation	Youth	$5,000	2027
Jim Button Youth Grant (Youth Central)	Foundation	Youth-led	$2,000	28 Oct 2026
Navacord Action Grant	Federation	Community	$1,000	31 Oct 2026

Source	Level	Focus	Maximum ask	Timing
Riipen Level UP	Federal-funded	Students	$1,400 per student, paid by Riipen	Jan–Mar 2027
Total Season One asks			**about $239,000**	

What we realistically expect: we weight each ask by its chance of success and by the share funders typically award. On that basis, Season One outside funding is expected at **about $50,000**, close to the **$49,730** Target budget. That is an average, not a promise. Some applications will exceed it and others will come up empty. **The McKenzie Towne Council's partnership is what turns that uncertainty into a guaranteed event.**

Why the Council's contribution is pivotal

1. **It provides the matching funds that larger grants require.** The City's Inspiring Neighbourhoods Grant requires an equal match. The Alberta CIP grant requires the applicant's contribution to at least equal the request, and caps provincial funding at 50% of project costs. The Council's cash (together with volunteer hours, which CIP values at $20–$40 an hour) is what makes these large asks eligible.
2. **It guarantees the event.** If grants fall short, the Council's commitment ensures the event proceeds at the Lean level rather than being cancelled.
3. **It signals confidence.** A strong commitment from the community's own amenities organization makes every other application more competitive.
4. **It costs the Council less as other funding succeeds.** Two-thirds of the Council's cash is released only against confirmed outside funding. If grants come in strongly, those funds are simply not drawn.

Season Two pipeline (2028)

A successful first year opens much larger sources, several of which need a track record:

- **Building Communities through Arts & Heritage: Local Festivals (Canadian Heritage):** up to **$200,000**, for festivals with a previous edition (deadline 15 Oct 2027)
- **Canada Post Community Foundation:** up to **$25,000** for youth programming (Feb 2027 application, Sept 2027 decision)
- **New Horizons for Seniors:** up to **$50,000** for an intergenerational strand, with seniors as storytellers and porch captains
- **Charity-partner sources** (TELUS Friendly Future Foundation, Calgary Foundation Community Grants, Calgary Flames Foundation): up to **$20,000–$100,000** each

With Season One delivered, the Council's share of future seasons should fall substantially.

PART 6

The Request, in Detail

Partnership options

To give the Board flexibility, we offer three levels. **We recommend the Founding Partner level.**

	Supporting Partner	Founding Partner (recommended)	Presenting Partner
Core contribution	$5,000	**$5,000**	$7,500
Match-contingent fund	—	**up to $10,000**	up to $15,000
Maximum cash	$5,000	**$15,000**	$22,500
In-kind (Hall, Prestwick Common, channels, storage)	Yes	**Yes**	Yes
What it secures	Lean event; grant matching	**Target event with student roles, at expected grant success**	Target event even if grants fall well short
Recognition	Community Partner	**Founding Partner + finale naming**	Presenting Partner + finale naming + Season Two founding credit

In-kind support requested

- **McKenzie Towne Hall:** about 12 evening planning sessions (Nov 2026–Aug 2027), two to three spring build days, and race-day headquarters, check-in and weather backup
- **Prestwick Common:** use as a station on race day
- **Communications:** inclusion in the Council's newsletters, social media and signage for recruitment and promotion
- **Storage:** a small space for props and the Lantern, kept for Season Two
- **Liaison:** one Council observer on the Steering Group

How funds are released (Founding Partner)

Tranche	Timing	Amount	Condition
1. Core	On approval (Nov 2026)	$5,000	Approved budget and safeguarding plan
2. Match-contingent	February 2027	up to $5,000	Matched dollar-for-dollar by **confirmed** grants or sponsorships
3. Match-contingent	May 2027	up to $5,000	Matched dollar-for-dollar by **confirmed** funding, including wage-subsidy decisions

Any match-contingent funds not drawn by **30 June 2027** stay with the Council.

PART 7

What the Council Receives

- **Presenting-partner billing:** *"The Wolf of McKenzie Towne, presented by the McKenzie Towne Council"* on posters, the invitation, registration materials, social media and signage
- **The McKenzie Towne Council Lantern Lighting:** naming of the finale moment, with an invitation for the Council President to light the Lantern
- **Recognition on race day:** banners at McKenzie Towne Hall and an Council-branded station
- **A youth presentation to the Board:** the Youth Race Council presents the plan in the spring and the results in the fall
- **An impact report** within 90 days: participation, volunteers, resident feedback, photos and a financial statement
- **Content for the Council's channels:** photography, video and a highlight reel for the Council's own communications
- **First right to partner on Season Two**, with founding-partner credit carried forward

PART 8

Accountability and Financial Controls

- **A dedicated account:** all event funds are held in a dedicated account of the host organization, with **two signatures** required on every payment.
- **Budget tracking:** expenses are tracked against the approved budget. Variances over 10% in any category are reported to the Council Liaison.
- **Monthly updates:** a one-page status report to the Council covering progress, funding secured, spending and risks.
- **Final report:** a full financial and impact report within **90 days** of the event.
- **Return of funds:** any unspent Council contribution is **returned to the McKenzie Towne Council** or, with the Council's written agreement, held for Season Two.
- **Records:** receipts and records are available to the Council's Controller on request.

PART 9

Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Grant funding falls short	Match-contingent release protects the Council; the event scales to the Lean budget rather than overspending
Participant injury	A safeguarding plan, a marshalled chase zone, walk-only streets, first aid on site, and insurance before activity
Damage to amenities	Play structures used as backdrops only; a park-care crew; cleanup commitment; a Council walk-through before and after
Weather	An indoor backup in McKenzie Towne Hall; a lightning or hail protocol
Volunteer shortfall	Student mentors, summer staff and street-by-street recruitment; clear, short volunteer shifts
Reputational risk	Vetted adults, a two-adult rule, a Council liaison, and transparent reporting
Noise or neighbour concerns	Advance notice to nearby residents; amplified sound ends well before quiet hours

PART 10

Timeline and Suggested Motion

When	Milestone
Nov 2026	Council decision; Tranche 1; grant applications submitted; Youth Race Council begins its planning missions
Dec 2026	Ward 12 fund application; Canada Summer Jobs application
Jan–Apr 2027	Student mentors begin; story, stations and safety plan finalized; youth presentation to the Council's Board
Feb 2027	Tranche 2 (match-contingent)
May 2027	Tranche 3 (match-contingent); summer staff begin; registration opens
Jul 2027	Full dress rehearsal; volunteer training
Late Aug 2027	**Race day and the McKenzie Towne Council Lantern Lighting**
Nov 2027	Impact and financial report to the Council; Season Two planning

Suggested motion

"That the McKenzie Towne Council become Founding Partner of The Wolf of McKenzie Towne youth community event (Season One, August 2027), and approve:

(1) a core contribution of $5,000, released upon approval of the event budget and safeguarding plan;

(2) a match-contingent commitment of up to $10,000, released in two tranches (February and May 2027) only against confirmed outside funding on a dollar-for-dollar basis, with undrawn amounts remaining with the McKenzie Towne Council after 30 June 2027;

(3) in-kind use of McKenzie Towne Hall, Prestwick Common, the Council's communication channels and prop storage as described in this proposal; and

(4) the appointment of an Council Liaison to the event's Steering Group;

subject to confirmation of event insurance, monthly reporting, and a final financial and impact report within 90 days of the event."

Closing

McKenzie Towne was built to be a village. Villages are held together by traditions that the whole community shares, and by young people who grow up knowing that their neighbours believe in them. This proposal asks the McKenzie Towne Council to help start one.

We would be glad to present this proposal in person, together with members of the Youth Race Council, at the Board's convenience.

Contact: [Name] · [Role] · [Phone] · [Email]

Supporting documents available on request: the full budget workbook, event overview and invitation, safeguarding plan, Youth Race Council planning guide (Mission Log), student placement postings, and the MTCA partnership summary.